PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Bond Accountability Committee

July 23rd, 2025

Meeting Minutes

Pursuant to notice made by posting on the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a meeting of the Bond Accountability Committee was held virtually and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsbondmodernizations

The materials for this meeting were posted on the Committee's Webpage https://www.pps.net/Page/466.

Attendance

Committee Members
Present:
Cara Turano (Committee Chair)
Greg DiLoreto
Annie Kwon
Chris Dunning
Ryan Kinsella
Travis George

Absent:
Norm Dowty
Jonathan Truitt
Jessie Dunham

Other Attendees
Stormy Shanks-Senior Director, Office of School Modernization (OSM)
Darren Lee-Director of Construction, OSM
Donna Bezio-Senior Project Manager-Wells, OSM
Erik Gerding-Senior Project Manager-Cleveland, OSM
Steve Effros-Senior Project Manager-Jefferson, OSM
Cathy Brady-Senior Auditor, Sjoberg Evashenk Consulting (SEC)
Lien Liu-Senior Auditor, SEC
Derek Henderson-Program Coordinator-OSM

Called to Order

The meeting was called to order at 5:32pm by Committee Chair Cara Turano.

Introductions

Welcome In! Committee and staff introductions and hello.

Public Comment

- No Public Comment

BAC Chair Nominations

- Cara Turano term as chair is up.
- OSM to send emails regarding chair nominations for Q4 meeting.
- New BOE expectations and reporting structure are currently being established, so we will know more by October 22, 2025.
- Discussion of potential co-chair structure for the committee.
- Need full BAC discussion, potentially do a special meeting just for the BAC nomination and election.
- OSM to poll members regarding nomination and selection process and next steps.

Q2 Meeting Minutes

- Adoption of minutes

Year 6 Performance Audit

Year 6 Audit Presentation by Sjoberg Evashenk Consulting
Report Highlights:

- Lincoln and HS-no recos
- Benson-recs
- 2020 delays and recos
- CBSE-no capital project movement
- Infrastructure-no recos
- Program staffing-lacking quantifiable hours-recos for creating a formula-not really sure what they are talking about—missing data for hours needed–possibly auditor idiocy–recommendation to create a limitation

Discussion:

- Central office hiring freeze affecting the bond as well, despite the difference in funding.
- How does OSM follow up on audits. Audit implementation team-critical obstacle–getting them completed is a challenge, and some of the things we don't have authority to change, just recommend.
- Small project implementation treatment for each recommendation
- What does the board do with any reports–board audit committee, review, and then direct as needed
- BAC question–100 million in savings unlikely—clarify
- Clarification of audit question (2020 goals needing to be reevaluated) 1700 kids, board, conversation around 52.35, something about reasonable, implementable, something, 8 years later, the reality, just wondering about ?????? NOT REALLY SURE WHAT THEY ARE SAYING, scope and cost related to ed specs?
- Board cost reduction ask–not based on a change in the standard or the scope, just the price. Audit period ended, cost reduction effort continued, savings and reductions understanding, BAC was clear on their stance.
- SFOIC active but not reporting to the board.
- PPS staff provides a lot of information to the board
- Oversight stuff-BAC technical oversight, objectivity, greater involvement
- Outstanding recos
- Need for executive leadership involvement in recos, OSM stretched too thin staff wise, oversight for reco recon.
- OSM now reports to DOCTOR JON FRANCO WHO IS A DOCTOR BECAUSE OTHER MADE UP DOCTORS SAID SO
- BAC discussion regarding BAC role–reporting to board, reporting to sub committee, now liaison from the BOE–splitt I think.
- SFOIC chair–Virginia LaForte
- Continued discussion about oversight and the role of the BAC overtime

Bond Program Administration Update

OSM Update on Program, 2012 Bond status, 2017 Bond status, 2020 Bond status
Discussion:

- Program contingency discussion, project savings return to contingency for reallocation to other projects.
- Discussion about the CBSE program development, the money and effort that has been spent so far, the role of OSM helping to inform on the purchase of a building that fit the vision of the CBSE.
- OSM was not part of the robust community engagement run by the district for the development of the CBSE program between 2020 and 2023.
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2017 Modernizations: Benson and MPG

Benson

Schedule and Progress Update and Project Highlights
Discussion:

- Discussion and clarification

MPG

Schedule and Progress Update and Project Highlights
Discussion:

- Discussion and clarification

2020/2025 Modernizations: Jefferson, Ida B. Wells, and Cleveland

Jefferson
Schedule and Progress Update and Project Highlights
Discussion:

- Cost reduction study discussion

Ida B. Wells
Schedule and Progress Update and Project Highlights
Discussion:

- Cost reduction study discussion

Cleveland
Schedule and Progress Update and Project Highlights
Discussion:

- Cost reduction study discussion

Adjourn

Cara Turano adjourned the meeting at 8:35pm.

Submitted by:

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Derek Henderson
Program Coordinator